Ho Lok Cheung

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EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles Expected December 2027
B.S. in Computer Science and Linguistics *Los Angeles, CA*

- **Regents Scholar**, UCLA's top 2% merit scholarship; Dean's Honors List (Spring 2026)
- Coursework: Algorithms and Complexity, Software Construction, Computer Organization, Programming Languages, Artificial Intelligence, Computational Linguistics

PROJECTS

TouchSpace | Code | *Python, FastAPI, React, TypeScript, Claude API* Oct 2026

- Won **Anthropic's Claude for Public Benefit Prize** at Cal Hacks 13.0 by building, on a 3-person team, a platform that turns LiDAR iPhone scans into tactile maps on a 2,400-pin Dot Pad display for blind and visually impaired users.
- Shipped a FastAPI backend whose **20 endpoints are covered by 153 automated tests**, plus a React web app, and converted Apple RoomPlan scans into floor plans and walkable navigation graphs.
- Ensured the AI cannot invent a route by limiting Claude to interpreting spoken questions while Dijkstra's algorithm computes every path from map data.

Naccent | Code | *Next.js, Python, Flask, Whisper API* Jan 2025

- Won **Best Student Life Hack** at SB Hacks XI by building an AI pronunciation trainer that transcribes speech with the OpenAI Whisper API and scores it phoneme by phoneme through SpeechAce and a Flask service.
- Improved accent and phoneme scoring by replacing an LLM-only approach; shipped a Next.js frontend with Chart.js analytics.

GreenMate | Demo | *Snap Spectacles, Lens Studio, AR* Oct 2024

- Won **1st Place** at the Columbia University Hackathon by building a Snap Spectacles AR app showing live plant health.

NeuralNurse | Code | *Python, Computer Vision, Facial Recognition* Feb 2024

- Won **2nd Place Overall** at UC Berkeley Hack for Impact by building a facial recognition assistant that identifies the people around you and recalls how you know them.

EXPERIENCE

Student Software Developer Aug 2026 – Present
UCLA Digital and Technology Solutions, Digital Spaces *Los Angeles, CA*

- Improve the reliability of classroom apps in UCLA's Learning Spaces Modernization Project by debugging issues and contributing fixes to shared codebases.
- Keep rewritten classroom app code maintainable for the full-time Digital Spaces engineers by documenting every change.

Project Manager Sep 2024 – Dec 2024
NASA L'SPACE Academy *Tempe, AZ*

- Delivered the full mission design review for a semi-autonomous lunar rover by leading a **team of 20**.

Research Intern | Paper Jun 2024 – Aug 2024
Stanford University *Palo Alto, CA*

- **First-authored a paper** showing that simulated populations readapt after their survival zone moves, by building a Python simulator of mutation, genome recombination, and natural selection on a spatial grid.
- Made mutation rates configurable by structuring the simulator around modular Creature, State, and Action classes.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: C++, C, Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, x86 Assembly
Web and Backend: React, Next.js, Node.js, Express.js, FastAPI, Flask, MongoDB, REST APIs, JWT Authentication
Tools and AI: Git, GitHub, Linux, Bash, SSH, Regex, Claude API, Claude Code, OpenAI Whisper API
Concepts: Data Structures and Algorithms, Multithreading (pthreads), Object-Oriented Design
Spoken Languages: Cantonese (native), Mandarin (fluent), English (fluent)

HONORS AND ACTIVITIES

- **8 hackathon prizes** in total; HackMIT and HackHarvard finalist
- USA Team Handball Academic All-American, 1st Team (2026); UCLA Rugby, Division I